

Couch to 5K: 8-Week Training Plan

Your Journey from the Sofa to the Finish Line

Introduction

The Couch to 5K (C25K) program is a tried-and-tested method for helping beginners become runners. It uses intervals of walking and running to build your cardiovascular fitness and leg strength gradually, minimizing the risk of injury.

Weekly Structure

Each week consists of 3 workout days with rest or light activity days in between.

- **Week 1:** 5 min warm-up walk, then 60s run / 90s walk (8 intervals), 5 min cool-down.
- **Week 2:** 5 min warm-up walk, then 90s run / 2 min walk (6 intervals), 5 min cool-down.
- **Week 3:** 5 min warm-up walk, then 2 x (90s run/90s walk, 3 min run/3 min walk), 5 min cool-down.
- **Week 4:** 5 min warm-up walk, then 3 min run, 90s walk, 5 min run, 2.5 min walk, 3 min run, 90s walk, 5 min run, 5 min cool-down.
- **Week 5:** Focus on longer continuous runs (up to 20 mins by the end of the week).
- **Week 6:** Re-introducing intervals but with longer run times (up to 25 mins total).
- **Week 7:** 25 min continuous run (3 sessions).
- **Week 8:** 28 min run -> 30 min run -> 5K Goal!

Essential Running Tips

1. **Proper Footwear:** Invest in quality running shoes.
2. **Slow Down:** You should be able to hold a conversation while running.
3. **Listen to Your Joints:** If something hurts (not just muscle soreness), rest.
4. **Hydrate:** Drink water throughout the day, not just during your run.
5. **Warm Up/Cool Down:** Never skip these 5-minute sessions.

Progress Tracker

Date	Week	Day	Completed?	Notes
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	1	1	[]	
	1	2	[]	
	1	3	[]	

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